Functional Skills English
Reading Level 2
Sample Paper 3

A City & Guilds Group Business

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Resolutions
Mark Scheme

Functional Skills English Level 2

Sample Assessment

Reading

Marking Scheme

Resolutions

Marking scheme

Key

Any words in brackets are not essential for the answer, eg, good (news).
A slash indicates an alternative answer, eg, paragraphs / sections.
(Accept similar wording) allows for paraphrasing and alternative wording.

Reading	Maximum marks	Criteria
1 What are **two** organisational features that have been used to help the reader locate the four main pieces of advice on keeping resolutions? Two from: • Subheadings • Bold • Paragraphs / sections • Centre justification • Images / pictures / icons / clip art • Short snappy sentences (1 mark for each correct answer – maximum 2 marks) (accept similar wording)	2 marks	16
2 Find **two** things Suki Tanaka says that suggests she personally struggles to meet her resolution goals. Two from: • (In news that surprises no one) least of all me • Much-needed light (on how to stick to resolutions) • Ok, this one is not as encouraging • No wonder I struggle to stay on target • I hope you all have better luck with them than I've had! (1 mark for each correct answer – maximum 2 marks) (accept similar wording)	2 marks	13
3 Give **three** words or phrases that are opinions from the first paragraph of Document 1. Three from: • (In news that) surprises no one • Disappointing (statistic) • Good (news) • Much-needed (light) (1 mark for each correct answer – maximum 3 marks)	3 marks	18

4 Why does Professor Anya Flores think so many resolutions fail on January 2nd? b) It is not the right time to make a change	1 mark	18
5 Which one of the following people uses a formal tone throughout their quoted comment in Document 1? a) Professor Lucy Daniels from Leeds University	1 mark	19

6 Apart from formal language, identify **two** language techniques used in Document 1 to convince the reader the information and advice is trustworthy. For each technique, give an example from the document. • **Facts and figures** E.g. One quarter / 1 in 10 • **Citing research / citing experts** E.g. Research from Leeds University found… / According to Ramesh Mahto, professor of social psychology… • **Direct quotes** E.g. "We studied 800 new goal setters…" • **Question and answer** E.g. So what's the reason for this disappointing statistic? Behavioural scientists have discovered that people tend to focus on what they are changing rather than why. • **Personal experience/anecdotes** E.g. No wonder I struggle to stay on target. • **Direct address** E.g. Now you just have to put it to good use • **Inclusive language** E.g. Like we all thought • **Persuasive language** E.g. The science behind sticking to your resolutions • **Idioms** E.g. Shed light on • **Metaphor** E.g. Pick concrete goals • **Conversational / colloquial / chatty / familiar language** E.g. Here's a nice one to begin with • **Humour** E.g Oops! No wonder I struggle to stay on target • **Self-deprecating language / contrasting expert with non-expert** E.g Those clever psychologists / Oops! No wonder I struggle to stay on target • **Bias** E.g It's crucial not to set vague goals • **Hyperbole** E.g In news that surprises no one • **Sarcasm** E.g In news that surprises no one • **Reassuring / encouraging tone** E.g But there's good news	4 marks	14

Accept any other justifiable technique with/without linked example (accept similar wording) 1 mark for each correct identified technique, with or without example (maximum of 2 marks) 1 mark for correct linked example (maximum of 2 marks). An incorrect example invalidates the technique.		
7 Which one of the following **best** summarises why the author of Document 2 thinks cycling makes a good New Year's resolution? a) Cycling offers benefits that help you stick to your goals	1 mark	11
8 Give one fact about the author of Document 2 that suggests his recommendations may be biased. One from: • Professional cyclist / cyclist for twelve years • He's writing for Greyhound Bicycles / he works for Greyhound Bicycles (accept similar wording)	1 mark	17

9 Give **three** examples of the author using a reassuring tone in Document 2. Answers may include but are not limited to: • You can keep your goals manageable • But that's the amazing thing about cycling – you can choose when you do it! • Gives you the flexibility and peace of mind • You can choose (to ride with friends, or alone) • We all achieve goals in different ways • Will give you the motivation you need to succeed • You can shake it up • It's perfect for beginners • You are sure to find a goal that suits you • Can become second nature in the blink of an eye • You will love your new bike • We don't think you will even notice these • You don't have to worry about punctures and other problems • And the more you learn about looking after your bike, the more confident you will feel riding it • Your amazing Greyhound bike • In a matter of weeks you'll create a lifestyle that will last forever **Accept any other justifiable answer** (1 mark for each correct answer – maximum 3 marks) (accept similar wording)	3 marks	19
10 The author of Document 2 is advising people to choose cycling as a New Year's resolution. What else is he trying to persuade the reader to do? b) Buy a Greyhound bike d) Cycle for charity	2 marks	13
11 Using evidence from the section headed *You can keep your goals manageable*, why does the author of Document 2 think that cycling allows for manageable goals? One from: • You can choose when you do it • You have flexibility / you are not tied in to set hours • You can choose which days are best for you • You can change your plans because of bad weather • You can choose a distance per week instead of set days (accept similar wording)	1 mark	18

12 Which one of the following bicycles would be best for someone entering the Long Ride event? c) Milestar	1 mark	15
13 Identify **three** biased phrases in the *You will love your new bike* section of Document 2. Three from: • Cycling is hard work • We don't think you will even notice these • Soaring (on your new bike) • You don't have to worry about punctures • The more you learn about looking after your bike, the more confident you will feel riding it (1 mark for each correct answer – maximum 3 marks)	3 marks	17
14 Document 1 says *Don't expect lasting change for at least 3 months*. What are **two** things the author of Document 2 says that shows he disagrees with this? Two from: • Try it for just one month and watch as your resolution becomes an unshakeable habit • That's how what starts as a resolution can become second nature in the blink of an eye • In a matter of weeks you'll create a lifestyle that will last forever! (1 mark for each correct answer – maximum 2 marks) (accept similar wording)	2 marks	12

15 Compare views from Documents 1 and 2 on how interacting with other people can affect success in keeping resolutions. Views from Document 1: • Partnering up with someone can boost the likelihood of seeing things through. • Joint planning helped people commit to new exercise regimes. • Starting something new with a friend significantly increased motivation. Views from Document 2: • Some find it easier to meet targets if we do it with friends • Some of us find more success when going it alone. • Quiet time alone will give you the motivation you need to succeed. Views from both documents: • Doing it with friends can make you more likely to succeed. (accept similar wording) **3 marks in total:** Evidence from 1 document only 1 piece of evidence from each document 1 piece of evidence from each document + 1 explicit comparison 1 piece of evidence from one document and 2 from the other 1 piece of evidence from one document and 2 from the other + 1 explicit comparison 1 piece of evidence from each + 2 explicit comparisons Maximum 3 marks. NB: comparisons must be explicit, not implicit, to be awarded any marks for the comparison element. The example below demonstrates explicit comparison on two separate occasions (underlined). Eg: Both documents say that it might be easier to achieve goals if you do it with someone else. However, only Document 2 says some people find more success when going it alone.	3 marks 0 marks 1 mark 2 marks 2 marks 3 marks 3 marks	12

Total marks available for Reading assessment	**30**
Indicative pass mark	**20**

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